

# **Project Report: Digital Literacy**

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# 1 Introduction

This project aims to build foundational digital literacy and professional skills essential for a modern engineering student. Transitioning into a professional academic environment requires more than just technical coding skills; it demands a clear understanding of digital etiquette, secure communication, and tool management. Throughout this project, I explored various platforms from organizing technical study tools and setting up version control portfolios on GitHub, to analyzing real-world cyber threats like UPI payment fraud. The objective was to transition from a passive consumer of technology to a responsible, secure digital citizen. This report documents the exact artifacts created, the platforms utilized, and my personal reflections on how these digital practices will safeguard my online identity.

## 2 Task 1 Write-up

For Task 1, I created a comprehensive guide titled "Mastering Digital Literacy," formatted cleanly using Markdown (`presentation.md`). I structured the guide into three core pillars: First, the **Student Toolbox**, highlighting essential productivity tools like Notion and Obsidian, academic research platforms like Google Scholar and Zotero, and programming basics via GitHub. Second, **Safe Communication**, addressing email etiquette and cyberbullying prevention. Third, **Digital Security**, covering practical advice on password management, public Wi-Fi safety, and phishing awareness.

Reflecting on this task, breaking down the vast topic of digital literacy into actionable, well-organized categories made the information much more digestible. It reinforced my understanding that digital literacy is not just about knowing how to use software, but understanding the responsibilities that come with being a "digital citizen."

## 3 Task 2 Write-up

In Task 2, I focused on building a professional online identity by linking key developer profiles in a `portfolio.md` file. The cornerstone of this setup was my GitHub profile, where I created a custom repository README to introduce myself as a Computer Science and Engineering student at VIT Bhopal University, outlining my technical stack (Python, Django, C++, and Machine Learning). Alongside GitHub, I linked my optimized LinkedIn profile to facilitate

professional networking, as well as my Stack Overflow account.

The purpose of centralizing these platforms is to establish a unified digital portfolio that showcases my ongoing projects and technical growth to future employers. Moving forward, my future plans involve consistently pushing my academic coursework to GitHub to build a strong commit history and actively engaging with the developer community on Stack Overflow.

## **4 Task 3 Write-up**

Task 3 was an interactive exercise focusing on practical skill application across two distinct platforms, documented in `platforms.md`. First, I utilized HackerRank to practice programming basics and logical problem-solving. I successfully completed a Python coding challenge, ensuring my logic passed all hidden test cases. This hands-on practice was invaluable for reinforcing algorithmic thinking.

Secondly, I used Google Forms to build a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. I configured various question types, such as multiple-choice checkboxes to identify phishing email red flags (e.g., generic greetings, suspicious sender domains, manufactured urgency) and short-answer questions regarding the security importance of software updates. Practicing on these platforms bridged the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical execution.

## **5 Task 4 Write-up**

Task 4 centered on digital communication and etiquette. I drafted formal, professional emails (`Emails.md`) for academic and professional scenarios. Additionally, I compiled a comprehensive checklist for responsible social media use (`social-media-checklist.md`).

The checklist outlines 5 essential Do's (such as curating a professional LinkedIn presence, verifying information before sharing, and taking screen breaks for mental health) and 5 critical Don'ts (such as sharing sensitive personal data like my student registration number, posting unprofessional content, or engaging in cyberbullying). The key learning from this scenario is that online communication requires a deliberate tone. A permanent digital footprint means that maintaining respect and clarity online is just as important as technical proficiency.

## 6 Task 5 Write-up

For Task 5, I conducted a deep dive into cybersecurity by writing a case study (`CaseStudy.md`) on UPI/Online Payment Fraud, specifically "The QR Code Marketplace Scam." The study detailed how scammers trick a university student selling a textbook into entering their UPI PIN under the guise of receiving an advance payment, resulting in a drained bank account.

I also created a "Stay Safe Online" `Prevention Checklist.md`, highlighting the Golden UPI Rule (a PIN is never needed to receive money), the danger of public Wi-Fi, and the Emergency Action Plan to call the 1930 helpline or visit [cybercrime.gov.in](https://cybercrime.gov.in). What surprised me most was how easily people fall for these scams due to social engineering and urgency, rather than complex hacking. Consequently, the primary habit I am changing is implementing a strict "Verify Before You Pay" rule to pause and check details before authorizing any digital transaction.

## 7 Conclusion

Completing this project has significantly bridged the gap between being a casual technology user and a digitally literate computer science student. From writing Markdown documentation and managing a GitHub portfolio to understanding the intricacies of UPI fraud and professional email etiquette, I have gained highly practical skills. The most vital takeaway is that digital safety and professionalism are active, ongoing responsibilities. The tools, platforms, and security habits I have established here will serve as a robust foundation for my academic success and future career.

## 8 References

- GitHub (Version Control & Portfolio): <https://github.com/>
- HackerRank (Coding Practice): <https://www.hackerrank.com/>
- Google Workspace (Forms): <https://docs.google.com/forms/>
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>